THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

ANNUAL REPORT AND FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

Company Registration No. 00048409 (England and Wales)

THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

COMPANY INFORMATION

Directors	Mr S Sadler	
	Mr J Winter	(Appointed 4 October 2023)
Company number	00048409	
Registered office	Bloomfield Road Stadium Seasiders Way Blackpool Lancashire FY1 6JJ	
Auditor	Champion Accountants LLP 1 Worsley Court High Street Worsley Manchester M28 3NJ	

THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

CONTENTS

	Page
Strategic report	1 - 2
Directors' report	3
Directors' responsibilities statement	4
Independent auditor's report	5 - 7
Profit and loss account	8
Statement of comprehensive income	9
Balance sheet	10
Statement of changes in equity	11
Notes to the financial statements	12 - 23

THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

STRATEGIC REPORT

FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

The directors present the strategic report for the year ended 30 June 2024.

Review of the business

The principal activity of the Company is that of a profess onal football club. In the year under review the Club was in EFL League One, the third tier of English professional football.

In the 2023–24 season, The Club competed in EFL League One, marking its return to the third tier following relegation from the Championship in the previous season. Despite a late rally, the team's efforts proved insufficient, culminating in an eighth-place finish with 73 points from 46 games, just two places outside the play-off spots.

Principal risks and uncertainties

The Club's divisional status within the professional football pyramid remains the most significant risk to the Group, as changes in league position materially affect revenue streams. Additionally, regulatory changes imposed by football authorities could further impact income.

The Group's board and senior management hold regular meetings to assess risks and take necessary actions to mitigate them.

Development and performance

The Directors remain committed to advancing the Football Club, with a strategy focused on:

- **Strengthening the scouting network** – Expanding domestic and international scouting capabilities, leveraging data analytics to identify and secure talented players within a sustainable financial model.
- **Enhancing youth development –** Investing in academy infrastructure, coaching, and clear player pathways to provide first-team opportunities for homegrown talent, reinforcing both club identity and financial sustainability.
- **Deepening community engagement** – Strengthening connections with supporters, grassroots football, and local initiatives through outreach programs and social impact projects to ensure long-term viability and positive contributions to the local area.
- **Ensuring financial sustainability** – Maintaining disciplined financial management, optimising revenue streams, and exploring commercial opportunities, sponsorships, and stadium enhancements to secure long-term stability.
- **Commitment to diversity, inclusion, and sustainability –** Promoting inclusivity, providing opportunities for underrepresented groups, and implementing environmentally sustainable practices across Club operations.

Key performance indicators

Revenue generation is a critical component of The Club's financial sustainability, particularly following the challenges associated with relegation. The table below highlights the key revenue streams that drive The Club's financial performance. These revenue streams are considered our Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) as they directly impact The Club's ability to operate effectively, invest in the playing squad, and plan for long term growth.

Revenue Stream	2024 (£)	2023 (£)	% Change	Key Observations
Matchday	4,464,780	5,345,837	-16.5%	Decrease due to lower attendance and reduced ticket pricing after relegation from the Championship.
Football	3,251,790	9,425,211	-65.5%	Significant drop due to reduced EFL central distributions.
Commercial	1,984,608	2,489,890	-20.3%	Lower sponsorship and advertising revenue, linked to reduced visibility in League One.
Total	9,701,178	17,260,938	-43.8%	Overall decrease after relegation from the Championship.

On behalf of the board

Mr J Winter
Director

24 March 2025

THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

DIRECTORS' REPORT

FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

The directors present their annual report and financial statements for the year ended 30 June 2024.

Principal activities
The principal activity of the company continued to be that of a professional football club.

Results and dividends
The results for the year are set out on page 8.

No ordinary dividends were paid. The directors do not recommend payment of a final dividend.

Directors
The directors who held office during the year and up to the date of signature of the financial statements were as follows:

Mr S Sadler
Mr J Winter (Appointed 4 October 2023)

Auditor
The auditor, Champion Accountants LLP, is deemed to be reappointed under section 487(2) of the Companies Act 2006.

Strategic report
The company has chosen in accordance with Companies Act 2006, s. 414C(11) to set out in the company's strategic report information required by Large and Medium-sized Companies and Groups (Accounts and Reports) Regulations 2008, Sch. 7 to be contained in the directors' report. It has done so in respect of future developments.

Statement of disclosure to auditor
So far as each person who was a director at the date of approving this report is aware, there is no relevant audit information of which the company's auditor is unaware. Additionally, the directors individually have taken all the necessary steps that they ought to have taken as directors in order to make themselves aware of all relevant audit information and to establish that the company's auditor is aware of that information.

Medium-sized companies exemption
This report has been prepared in accordance with the provisions applicable to companies entitled to the medium-sized companies exemption.

On behalf of the board

Mr J Winter
Director

24 March 2025

THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

DIRECTORS' RESPONSIBILITIES STATEMENT

FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

The directors are responsible for preparing the annual report and the financial statements in accordance with applicable law and regulations.

Company law requires the directors to prepare financial statements for each financial year. Under that law the directors have elected to prepare the financial statements in accordance with United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice (United Kingdom Accounting Standards and applicable law). Under company law, the directors must not approve the financial statements unless they are satisfied that they give a true and fair view of the state of affairs of the company and of the profit or loss of the company for that period.

In preparing these financial statements, the directors are required to:

- select suitable accounting policies and then apply them consistently;
- make judgements and accounting estimates that are reasonable and prudent; and
- prepare the financial statements on the going concern basis unless it is inappropriate to presume that the company will continue in business.

The directors are responsible for keeping adequate accounting records that are sufficient to show and explain the company's transactions and disclose with reasonable accuracy at any time the financial position of the company and enable them to ensure that the financial statements comply with the Companies Act 2006. They are also responsible for safeguarding the assets of the company and hence for taking reasonable steps for the prevention and detection of fraud and other irregularities.

THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT

TO THE MEMBERS OF THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

Opinion

We have audited the financial statements of The Blackpool Football Club Limited (the 'company') for the year ended 30 June 2024 which comprise the profit and loss account, the statement of comprehensive income, the balance sheet, the statement of changes in equity and notes to the financial statements, including significant accounting policies. The financial reporting framework that has been applied in their preparation is applicable law and United Kingdom Accounting Standards, including Financial Reporting Standard 102 *The Financial Reporting Standard applicable in the UK and Republic of Ireland* (United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice).

In our opinion the financial statements:

- give a true and fair view of the state of the company's affairs as at 30 June 2024 and of its loss for the year then ended;
- have been properly prepared in accordance with United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice; and
- have been prepared in accordance with the requirements of the Companies Act 2006.

Basis for opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (UK) (ISAs (UK)) and applicable law. Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in the *Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements* section of our report. We are independent of the company in accordance with the ethical requirements that are relevant to our audit of the financial statements in the UK, including the FRC's Ethical Standard, and we have fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with these requirements. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

Conclusions relating to going concern

In auditing the financial statements, we have concluded that the directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting in the preparation of the financial statements is appropriate.

Based on the work we have performed, we have not identified any material uncertainties relating to events or conditions that, individually or collectively, may cast significant doubt on the company's ability to continue as a going concern for a period of at least twelve months from when the financial statements are authorised for issue.

Our responsibilities and the responsibilities of the directors with respect to going concern are described in the relevant sections of this report.

Other information

The other information comprises the information included in the annual report other than the financial statements and our auditor's report thereon. The directors are responsible for the other information contained within the annual report. Our opinion on the financial statements does not cover the other information and, except to the extent otherwise explicitly stated in our report, we do not express any form of assurance conclusion thereon. Our responsibility is to read the other information and, in doing so, consider whether the other information is materially inconsistent with the financial statements or our knowledge obtained in the course of the audit, or otherwise appears to be materially misstated. If we identify such material inconsistencies or apparent material misstatements, we are required to determine whether this gives rise to a material misstatement in the financial statements themselves. If, based on the work we have performed, we conclude that there is a material misstatement of this other information, we are required to report that fact.

We have nothing to report in this regard.

Opinions on other matters prescribed by the Companies Act 2006

In our opinion, based on the work undertaken in the course of our audit:

- the information given in the strategic report and the directors' report for the financial year for which the financial statements are prepared is consistent with the financial statements; and
- the strategic report and the directors' report have been prepared in accordance with applicable legal requirements.

Matters on which we are required to report by exception

In the light of the knowledge and understanding of the company and its environment obtained in the course of the audit, we have not identified material misstatements in the strategic report or the directors' report.

We have nothing to report in respect of the following matters in relation to which the Companies Act 2006 requires us to report to you if, in our opinion:

- adequate accounting records have not been kept, or returns adequate for our audit have not been received from branches not visited by us; or
- the financial statements are not in agreement with the accounting records and returns; or
- certain disclosures of remuneration specified by law are not made; or
- we have not received all the information and explanations we require for our audit.

Responsibilities of directors

As explained more fully in the directors' responsibilities statement, the directors are responsible for the preparation of the financial statements and for being satisfied that they give a true and fair view, and for such internal control as the directors determine is necessary to enable the preparation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error. In preparing the financial statements, the directors are responsible for assessing the company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting unless the directors either intend to liquidate the company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so.

Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs (UK) will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these financial statements.

The extent to which our procedures are capable of detecting irregularities, including fraud, is detailed below.

As part of our planning process:

- We enquired of management the systems and controls the company has in place, the areas of the financial statements that are mostly susceptible to the risk of irregularities and fraud, and whether there was any known, suspected or alleged fraud. Management did not inform us of any known, suspected or alleged fraud.
- We obtained an understanding of the legal and regulatory frameworks applicable to the company. We determined that the following were most relevant: FRS 102, Companies Act 2006 and compliance with the Financial Fair Play regulations as set out by the English Football League (EFL).
- We considered the incentives and opportunities that exist in the company, including the extent of management bias, which present a potential for irregularities and fraud to be perpetuated, and tailored our risk assessment accordingly.
- Using our knowledge of the company, together with discussions held with management at the planning stage, we formed a conclusion on the risk of misstatement due to irregularities including fraud and tailored our procedures according to this risk assessment.

The key procedures we undertook to detect irregularities including fraud during the course of the audit included:

- Identifying and testing journal entries and the overall accounting records, in particular those that were significant and unusual
- Reviewing the financial statement disclosures and determining whether accounting policies have been appropriately applied.
- Reviewing and challenging the assumptions and judgements used by management in their significant accounting estimates, in particular in relation to doubtful debt provisions and depreciation and amortisation methods.
- Assessing the extent of compliance, or lack of, with the relevant laws and regulations.
- Testing key revenue lines, including cut-off, for evidence of management bias.
- Obtaining third-party confirmation of material bank balances.
- Documenting and verifying all significant related party balances and transactions.

There are inherent limitations in our audit procedures described above. The more removed that laws and regulations are from financial transactions, the less likely it is that we would become aware of non-compliance. Auditing standards also limit the audit procedures required to identify non-compliance with laws and regulations to enquiry of the directors and other management and the inspection of regulatory and legal correspondence, if any. Material misstatements that arise due to fraud can be harder to detect than those that arise from error as they may involve deliberate concealment or collusion.

A further description of our responsibilities is available on the Financial Reporting Council's website at: https://www.frc.org.uk/auditorsresponsibilities. This description forms part of our auditor's report.

Use of our report

This report is made solely to the company's members, as a body, in accordance with Chapter 3 of Part 16 of the Companies Act 2006. Our audit work has been undertaken so that we might state to the company's members those matters we are required to state to them in an auditor's report and for no other purpose. To the fullest extent permitted by law, we do not accept or assume responsibility to anyone other than the company and the company's members as a body, for our audit work, for this report, or for the opinions we have formed.

Mark Turner FCA (Senior Statutory Auditor)
For and on behalf of Champion Accountants LLP, Statutory Auditor
Chartered Accountants
1 Worsley Court
High Street
Worsley
Manchester
M28 3NJ
24 March 2025

THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

PROFIT AND LOSS ACCOUNT

FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

	Notes	2024 £	2023 £
Turnover	3	9,701,178	17,260,938
Cost of sales		(1,273,368)	(1,434,970)
Gross profit		8,427,810	15,825,968
Administrative expenses		(14,648,671)	(19,012,344)
Operating loss	4	(6,220,861)	(3,186,376)
Profit/ loss on disposal of player registrations	7	2,281,092	2,926,636
Loss before taxation		(3,939,769)	(259,740)
Tax on loss	8	1,128,497	146,148
Loss for the financial year		(2,811,272)	(113,592)

The profit and loss account has been prepared on the basis that all operations are continuing operations.

THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

STATEMENT OF COMPREHENSIVE INCOME

FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

	2024 £	2023 £
Loss for the year	(2,811,272)	(113,592)
Other comprehensive income	-	-
Total comprehensive income for the year	(2,811,272)	(113,592)

THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

BALANCE SHEET

AS AT 30 JUNE 2024

	Notes	2024 £	2024 £	2023 £	2023 £
Fixed assets					
Intangible assets	**9**		1,392,942		1,741,644
Tangible assets	**10**		1,271,515		1,184,006
			2,664,457		2,925,650
Current assets					
Stocks	**11**	203,689		246,346	
Debtors falling due after more than one year	**12**	866,666		762,500	
Debtors falling due within one year	**12**	9,581,318		7,154,771	
Cash at bank and in hand		319,763		948,233	
		10,971,436		9,111,850	
Creditors: amounts falling due within one year	**13**	(23,762,556)		(19,637,442)	
Net current liabilities			(12,791,120)		(10,525,592)
Total assets less current liabilities			(10,126,663)		(7,599,942)
Creditors: amounts falling due after more than one year	**14**		(349,662)		(65,111)
Net liabilities			(10,476,325)		(7,665,053)
Capital and reserves					
Called up share capital	**18**		37,500		37,500
Share premium account			1,860,174		1,860,174
Capital redemption reserve			2,335		2,335
Profit and loss reserves			(12,376,334)		(9,565,062)
Total equity			(10,476,325)		(7,665,053)

These financial statements have been prepared in accordance with the provisions relating to medium-sized companies.

The financial statements were approved by the board of directors and authorised for issue on 24 March 2025 and are signed on its behalf by:

Mr J Winter
Director

Company registration number 00048409 (England and Wales)

THE BLACKPOOL FOOTBALL CLUB LIMITED

STATEMENT OF CHANGES IN EQUITY

FOR THE YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

	Share capital	Share premium account	Capital redemption reserve	Profit and loss reserves	Total
	£	£	£	£	£
Balance at 1 July 2022	37,500	1,860,174	2,335	(9,451,470)	(7,551,461)
Year ended 30 June 2023:					
Loss and total comprehensive income	-	-	-	(113,592)	(113,592)
Balance at 30 June 2023	37,500	1,860,174	2,335	(9,565,062)	(7,665,053)
Year ended 30 June 2024:					
Loss and total comprehensive income	-	-	-	(2,811,272)	(2,811,272)
Balance at 30 June 2024	37,500	1,860,174	2,335	(12,376,334)	(10,476,325)

1 Accounting policies

Company information

The Blackpool Football Club Limited is a private company limited by shares incorporated in England and Wales. The registered office is Bloomfield Road Stadium, Seasiders Way, Blackpool, Lancashire, FY1 6JJ.

1.1 Accounting convention

These financial statements have been prepared in accordance with FRS 102 "The Financial Reporting Standard applicable in the UK and Republic of Ireland" ("FRS 102") and the requirements of the Companies Act 2006.

The financial statements are prepared in sterling, which is the functional currency of the company. Monetary amounts in these financial statements are rounded to the nearest £.

The financial statements have been prepared under the historical cost convention. The principal accounting policies adopted are set out below.

This company is a qualifying entity for the purposes of FRS 102, being a member of a group where the parent of that group prepares publicly available consolidated financial statements, including this company, which are intended to give a true and fair view of the assets, liabilities, financial position and profit or loss of the group. The company has therefore taken advantage of exemptions from the following disclosure requirements:

- Section 7 'Statement of Cash Flows': Presentation of a statement of cash flow and related notes and disclosures;
- Section 33 'Related Party Disclosures': Compensation for key management personnel.

The financial statements of the company are consolidated in the financial statements of Blackpool Football Club Holdings Ltd. These consolidated financial statements are available from its registered office, Bloomfield Road Stadium, Seasiders Way, Blackpool, United Kingdom, FY1 6JJ.

1.2 Going concern

At the time of approving the financial statements, the directors have a reasonable expectation that the company has adequate resources to continue in operational existence for the foreseeable future. Thus the directors continue to adopt the going concern basis of accounting in preparing the financial statements.

1.3 Turnover

Turnover is recognised at the fair value of the consideration received or receivable for goods and services provided in the normal course of business, and is shown net of VAT and other sales related taxes.

Television and media income is recognised over the course of the season. Season ticket, gate receipt and match streaming income is recognised at the point the relevant match is played. Sponsorship income is recognised over the term of the contract. Catering, retail and merchandise sales are recognised at the point of sale.

When cash inflows are deferred and represent a financing arrangement, the fair value of the consideration is the present value of the future receipts. The difference between the fair value of the consideration and the nominal amount received is recognised as interest income.

1.4 Intangible fixed assets other than goodwill

Intangible assets represent guaranteed transfer fees and associated costs payable, in relation to the transfer of players' registrations. These amounts are amortised as follows:

Players' registrations	Over the remaining term of the contract

1 Accounting policies **(Continued)**

1.5 Tangible fixed assets

Tangible fixed assets are initially measured at cost and subsequently measured at cost or valuation, net of depreciation and any impairment losses.

Depreciation is recognised so as to write off the cost or valuation of assets less their residual values over their useful lives on the following bases:

Leasehold land and buildings	5% straight line
Plant and equipment	10% straight line
Fixtures and fittings	33% straight line
Motor vehicles	25% straight line

The gain or loss arising on the disposal of an asset is determined as the difference between the sale proceeds and the carrying value of the asset, and is credited or charged to profit or loss.

1.6 Impairment of fixed assets

At each reporting period end date, the company reviews the carrying amounts of its tangible and intangible assets to determine whether there is any indication that those assets have suffered an impairment loss. If any such indication exists, the recoverable amount of the asset is estimated in order to determine the extent of the impairment loss (if any). Where it is not possible to estimate the recoverable amount of an individual asset, the company estimates the recoverable amount of the cash-generating unit to which the asset belongs.

Recoverable amount is the higher of fair value less costs to sell and value in use. In assessing value in use, the estimated future cash flows are discounted to their present value using a pre-tax discount rate that reflects current market assessments of the time value of money and the risks specific to the asset for which the estimates of future cash flows have not been adjusted.

If the recoverable amount of an asset (or cash-generating unit) is estimated to be less than its carrying amount, the carrying amount of the asset (or cash-generating unit) is reduced to its recoverable amount. An impairment loss is recognised immediately in profit or loss, unless the relevant asset is carried at a revalued amount, in which case the impairment loss is treated as a revaluation decrease.

Recognised impairment losses are reversed if, and only if, the reasons for the impairment loss have ceased to apply. Where an impairment loss subsequently reverses, the carrying amount of the asset (or cash-generating unit) is increased to the revised estimate of its recoverable amount, but so that the increased carrying amount does not exceed the carrying amount that would have been determined had no impairment loss been recognised for the asset (or cash-generating unit) in prior years. A reversal of an impairment loss is recognised immediately in profit or loss, unless the relevant asset is carried at a revalued amount, in which case the reversal of the impairment loss is treated as a revaluation increase.

1.7 Stocks

Stocks are stated at the lower of cost and estimated selling price less costs to complete and sell. Cost comprises direct materials and, where applicable, direct labour costs and those overheads that have been incurred in bringing the stocks to their present location and condition.
At each reporting date, an assessment is made for impairment. Any excess of the carrying amount of stocks over its estimated selling price less costs to complete and sell is recognised as an impairment loss in profit or loss. Reversals of impairment losses are also recognised in profit or loss.

1.8 Cash and cash equivalents

Cash and cash equivalents are basic financial assets and include cash in hand, deposits held at call with banks, other short-term liquid investments with original maturities of three months or less, and bank overdrafts. Bank overdrafts are shown within borrowings in current liabilities.

1 Accounting policies **(Continued)**

1.9 Financial instruments

The company has elected to apply the provisions of Section 11 'Basic Financial Instruments' and Section 12 'Other Financial Instruments Issues' of FRS 102 to all of its financial instruments.

Financial instruments are recognised in the company's balance sheet when the company becomes party to the contractual provisions of the instrument.

Financial assets and liabilities are offset, with the net amounts presented in the financial statements, when there is a legally enforceable right to set off the recognised amounts and there is an intention to settle on a net basis or to realise the asset and settle the liability simultaneously.

Basic financial assets

Basic financial assets, which include debtors and cash and bank balances, are initially measured at transaction price including transaction costs and are subsequently carried at amortised cost using the effective interest method unless the arrangement constitutes a financing transaction, where the transaction is measured at the present value of the future receipts discounted at a market rate of interest. Financial assets classified as receivable within one year are not amortised.

Other financial assets

Other financial assets, including investments in equity instruments which are not subsidiaries, associates or joint ventures, are initially measured at fair value, which is normally the transaction price. Such assets are subsequently carried at fair value and the changes in fair value are recognised in profit or loss, except that investments in equity instruments that are not publicly traded and whose fair values cannot be measured reliably are measured at cost less impairment.

Impairment of financial assets

Financial assets, other than those held at fair value through profit and loss, are assessed for indicators of impairment at each reporting end date.

Financial assets are impaired where there is objective evidence that, as a result of one or more events that occurred after the initial recognition of the financial asset, the estimated future cash flows have been affected. If an asset is impaired, the impairment loss is the difference between the carrying amount and the present value of the estimated cash flows discounted at the asset's original effective interest rate. The impairment loss is recognised in profit or loss.

If there is a decrease in the impairment loss arising from an event occurring after the impairment was recognised, the impairment is reversed. The reversal is such that the current carrying amount does not exceed what the carrying amount would have been, had the impairment not previously been recognised. The impairment reversal is recognised in profit or loss.

Derecognition of financial assets

Financial assets are derecognised only when the contractual rights to the cash flows from the asset expire or are settled, or when the company transfers the financial asset and substantially all the risks and rewards of ownership to another entity, or if some significant risks and rewards of ownership are retained but control of the asset has transferred to another party that is able to sell the asset in its entirety to an unrelated third party.

Classification of financial liabilities

Financial liabilities and equity instruments are classified according to the substance of the contractual arrangements entered into. An equity instrument is any contract that evidences a residual interest in the assets of the company after deducting all of its liabilities.

1 Accounting policies **(Continued)**

Basic financial liabilities

Basic financial liabilities, including creditors, bank loans, loans from fellow group companies and preference shares that are classified as debt, are initially recognised at transaction price unless the arrangement constitutes a financing transaction, where the debt instrument is measured at the present value of the future payments discounted at a market rate of interest. Financial liabilities classified as payable within one year are not amortised.

Debt instruments are subsequently carried at amortised cost, using the effective interest rate method.

Trade creditors are obligations to pay for goods or services that have been acquired in the ordinary course of business from suppliers. Amounts payable are classified as current liabilities if payment is due within one year or less. If not, they are presented as non-current liabilities. Trade creditors are recognised initially at transaction price and subsequently measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method.

Other financial liabilities

Debt instruments that do not meet the conditions in FRS 102 paragraph 11.9 are subsequently measured at fair value through profit or loss. Debt instruments may be designated as being measured at fair value through profit or loss to eliminate or reduce an accounting mismatch or if the instruments are measured and their performance evaluated on a fair value basis in accordance with a documented risk management or investment strategy.

Derecognition of financial liabilities

Financial liabilities are derecognised when the company's contractual obligations expire or are discharged or cancelled.

1.10 Equity instruments

Equity instruments issued by the company are recorded at the proceeds received, net of transaction costs. Dividends payable on equity instruments are recognised as liabilities once they are no longer at the discretion of the company.

1.11 Taxation

The tax expense represents the sum of the tax currently payable and deferred tax.

Current tax

The tax currently payable is based on taxable profit for the year. Taxable profit differs from net profit as reported in the profit and loss account because it excludes items of income or expense that are taxable or deductible in other years and it further excludes items that are never taxable or deductible. The company's liability for current tax is calculated using tax rates that have been enacted or substantively enacted by the reporting end date.

1.12 Employee benefits

The costs of short-term employee benefits are recognised as a liability and an expense, unless those costs are required to be recognised as part of the cost of stock or fixed assets.

The cost of any unused holiday entitlement is recognised in the period in which the employee's services are received.

Termination benefits are recognised immediately as an expense when the company is demonstrably committed to terminate the employment of an employee or to provide termination benefits.

1.13 Retirement benefits

Payments to defined contribution retirement benefit schemes are charged as an expense as they fall due.

1 Accounting policies **(Continued)**

1.14 Foreign exchange

Transactions in currencies other than pounds sterling are recorded at the rates of exchange prevailing at the dates of the transactions. At each reporting end date, monetary assets and liabilities that are denominated in foreign currencies are retranslated at the rates prevailing on the reporting end date. Gains and losses arising on translation in the period are included in profit or loss.

2 Judgements and key sources of estimation uncertainty

In the application of the company's accounting policies, the directors are required to make judgements, estimates and assumptions about the carrying amount of assets and liabilities that are not readily apparent from other sources. The estimates and associated assumptions are based on historical experience and other factors that are considered to be relevant. Actual results may differ from these estimates.

The estimates and underlying assumptions are reviewed on an ongoing basis. Revisions to accounting estimates are recognised in the period in which the estimate is revised where the revision affects only that period, or in the period of the revision and future periods where the revision affects both current and future periods.

Key sources of estimation uncertainty

The estimates and assumptions which have a significant risk of causing a material adjustment to the carrying amount of assets and liabilities are as follows.

Impairment of trade debtors

At each balance sheet date, the directors and the finance team review outstanding debtor balances to estimate which, if any, should be impaired or provided against. This calculation involves judgement and is based on factors such as the financial position of the customer, historical payment patterns, and any ongoing discussions between the company and its customers.

At 30 June 2024, the outstanding trade debtors amounted to £2,928,824, which is stated net of a provision of £1,740. The estimation of the impairment provision involves uncertainty and may be revised in the future depending on changes in the financial position of customers.

Useful economic life of tangible fixed assets

The useful economic life of tangible assets is judged at the point of purchase and reviewed at each financial reporting date. This judgement is based upon the directors' in depth knowledge of the industry in which the company operates and their understanding of the individual assets .

As standard, a useful economic life of 10 years is applied to plant and equipment, 3 years to fixtures and fittings, and 4 years to motor vehicles. These estimates are reviewed periodically and may be adjusted based on factors such as changes in industry practices, asset usage, or technological advancements. The net book value of tangible fixed assets at 30 June 2024 is £1,271,516.

3 Turnover and other revenue

	2024	2023
	£	£
Turnover analysed by class of business		
Matchday	4,464,780	5,345,837
Football	3,251,790	9,425,211
Commercial	1,984,608	2,489,890
	9,701,178	17,260,938

3 Turnover and other revenue (Continued)

	2024	2023
	£	£
Turnover analysed by geographical market		
UK	9,701,178	17,260,938

4 **Operating loss**

	2024	2023
Operating loss for the year is stated after charging/(crediting):	£	£
Exchange losses/(gains)	333	(7,433)
Fees payable to the company's auditor for the audit of the company's financial statements	15,200	9,200
Depreciation of owned tangible fixed assets	216,554	207,508
Amortisation of intangible assets	1,218,955	1,193,757

5 **Employees**

The average monthly number of persons (including directors) employed by the company during the year was:

	2024	2023
	Number	Number
Footballers, coaches and managers	94	99
Administrative and other staff	47	41
Total	141	140

In addition, the company engaged on match days an average of 96 part-time temporary staff (2023- 230).

Their aggregate remuneration comprised:

	2024	2023
	£	£
Wages and salaries	8,531,943	12,214,810
Social security costs	896,616	1,273,371
Pension costs	79,653	40,418
	9,508,212	13,528,599

6 Directors' remuneration

	2024	2023
	£	£
Remuneration for qualifying services	137,417	353,772
Company pension contributions to defined contribution schemes	3,520	421
	140,937	354,193

The number of directors for whom retirement benefits are accruing under defined contribution schemes amounted to 1 (2023 - 2).

Remuneration disclosed above include the following amounts paid to the highest paid director:

	2024	2023
	£	£
Remuneration for qualifying services	n/a	334,554

As total directors' remuneration was less than £200,000 in the current year, no disclosure is provided for that year.

7 Other gains and losses

	2024	2023
	£	£
Profit/ loss on disposal of player registrations	2,281,092	2,926,636

Profit/loss on disposal of player registrations represents guaranteed transfer fees receivable, less the carrying value of those players at the date of disposal. This figure also includes contingent transfer fees which have become receivable in respect of the transfer of players' registrations in previous periods.

8 Taxation

	2024	2023
	£	£
Current tax		
Group tax relief	(1,128,497)	(146,148)

8 **Taxation** **(Continued)**

The actual credit for the year can be reconciled to the expected credit for the year based on the profit or loss and the standard rate of tax as follows:

	2024 £	2023 £
Loss before taxation	(3,939,769)	(259,740)
Expected tax credit based on the standard rate of corporation tax in the UK of 25.00% (2023: 20.50%)	(984,942)	(53,247)
Tax effect of expenses that are not deductible in determining taxable profit	279,277	146,274
Tax effect of income not taxable in determining taxable profit	(422,832)	(231,487)
Other adjustments	-	(7,688)
Taxation credit for the year	(1,128,497)	(146,148)

9 **Intangible fixed assets**

	Players' registrations £
Cost	
At 1 July 2023	3,837,924
Additions	1,214,193
Disposals	(1,717,668)
At 30 June 2024	3,334,449
Amortisation and impairment	
At 1 July 2023	2,096,280
Amortisation charged for the year	1,218,955
Disposals	(1,373,728)
At 30 June 2024	1,941,507
Carrying amount	
At 30 June 2024	1,392,942
At 30 June 2023	1,741,644

10 Tangible fixed assets

	Leasehold land and buildings	Plant and equipment	Fixtures and fittings	Motor vehicles	Total
	£	£	£	£	£
Cost					
At 1 July 2023	152,026	2,008,767	382,416	37,450	2,580,659
Additions	-	264,389	39,674	-	304,063
At 30 June 2024	152,026	2,273,156	422,090	37,450	2,884,722
Depreciation and impairment					
At 1 July 2023	25,550	1,039,628	316,569	14,906	1,396,653
Depreciation charged in the year	7,601	148,656	50,935	9,362	216,554
At 30 June 2024	33,151	1,188,284	367,504	24,268	1,613,207
Carrying amount					
At 30 June 2024	118,875	1,084,872	54,586	13,182	1,271,515
At 30 June 2023	126,476	969,139	65,847	22,544	1,184,006

11 Stocks

	2024	2023
	£	£
Finished goods and goods for resale	203,689	246,346

12 Debtors

	2024	2023
Amounts falling due within one year:	£	£
Trade debtors	2,928,828	2,091,261
Amounts owed by group undertakings	4,695,196	2,427,912
Other debtors	1,489,736	1,753,898
Prepayments and accrued income	467,558	881,700
	9,581,318	7,154,771

	2024	2023
Amounts falling due after more than one year:	£	£
Trade debtors	866,666	762,500
Total debtors	10,447,984	7,917,271

12 Debtors **(Continued)**

Trade debtors are stated net of a provision of £1,740 (2023: £100,777).

Other debtors are stated net of a provision of £243,250 (2023: £243,250).

13 Creditors: amounts falling due within one year

	Notes	2024 £	2023 £
Other borrowings	15	-	58,496
Trade creditors		730,856	909,590
Amounts owed to group undertakings		20,885,707	15,898,080
Taxation and social security		414,761	461,649
Deferred income	16	1,356,747	1,970,712
Other creditors		11,602	18,066
Accruals		362,883	320,849
		23,762,556	19,637,442

14 Creditors: amounts falling due after more than one year

	2024 £	2023 £
Trade creditors	274,770	40,000
Accruals and deferred income	74,892	25,111
	349,662	65,111

15 Loans and overdrafts

	2024 £	2023 £
Other loans	-	58,496
Payable within one year	-	58,496

16 Deferred income

	2024 £	2023 £
Other deferred income	1,356,747	1,970,712

17 Retirement benefit schemes

Defined contribution schemes	2024 £	2023 £
Charge to profit or loss in respect of defined contribution schemes	79,653	40,418

The company operates a defined contribution pension scheme for all qualifying employees. The assets of the scheme are held separately from those of the company in an independently administered fund.

18 Share capital

Ordinary share capital	2024 Number	2023 Number	2024 £	2023 £
Issued and fully paid				
Ordinary shares of £1 each	37,500	37,500	37,500	37,500

19 Contingent transfer fees

Following the sale of certain players, additional transfer fees are expected to become receivable of £30,000 (2023: £20,000) at various stages in the future, contingent on the relevant players triggering certain appearance and performance based clauses.

Following the purchase of certain players, additional transfer fees are expected to become payable of £31,250 (2023: £100,000) at various stages in the future, contingent on the relevant players triggering certain appearance and performance based clauses.

20 Operating lease commitments

At the reporting end date the company had outstanding commitments for future minimum lease payments under non-cancellable operating leases, which fall due as follows:

	2024 £	2023 £
Within one year	1,422	10,236
Between two and five years	-	1,422
	1,422	11,658

21 Related party transactions

Amounts due to related parties	2024 £	2023 £
Entities with control, joint control or significant influence over the company	20,885,707	15,898,080

21 Related party transactions **(Continued)**

The following amounts were outstanding at the reporting end date:

Amounts due from related parties	**2024** **£**	**2023** **£**
Entities with control, joint control or significant influence over the company	378,426	-
Other related parties	4,316,770	2,427,912

Other information

Balances due to and from related parties are unsecured, interest free and repayable on demand.

Blackpool F.C. Community Trust currently occupies offices within The Blackpool Football Club Limited's serviced accommodation rent-free. Deeds of Assignment have been made between The Blackpool Football Club Limited and Blackpool F.C. Community Trust, dated 4 February 2018 and 10 May 2019 for the occupation of training offices in the stadium for a period of 25 years rent-free.

Included within other debtors are amounts due from former related parties totalling £243,250 (2023: £243,250). The amount provided against these balances was £243,250 (2023: £243,250).

22 Ultimate controlling party

The parent company is Blackpool Football Club Holdings Ltd, registered office address: Bloomfield Road Stadium, Seasiders Way, Blackpool, United Kingdom, FY1 6JJ.

The ultimate parent company is Seaside Holdings Ltd, a company registered in the Cayman Islands. The registered office is The offices of Maples Corporate Services Limited, PO Box 309, Ugland House, Grand Cayman, KY1-1104, Cayman Islands.

The ultimate controlling party is Mr S P Sadler, shareholder of the ultimate parent company Seaside Holdings Ltd.

23 Football League Pension Costs

Certain ex-employees of the club are members of the closed Football League Limited Life Assurance Scheme, a defined benefit scheme. Due to the fact that the company is one of a number of participating employers in the scheme, it isn't possible to accurately identify a surplus or deficit. However, under Section 75 of the Pensions Act 1995, the company is liable to fund the deficit relating to the ex-employees who are members of the scheme.

The liability calculated by the trustees at 30 June 2024 and allocated to the company amounted to £31,599 (2023 : £25,111), and this amount has been accrued accordingly. The assets of the scheme are held separately from those of the company.

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